

Helicopter

The aircraft that made people's heads SPIN

It took many attempts to get a helicopter into the air. Once it got there, however, it performed aerial acrobatics that left planes in the dust.

This rescue helicopter is designed to hold four crew members and up to six additional people.

Leonardo's aerial screw used a revolving platform to make it rise upward.

Aerial screw

More than **400 years** before the first helicopter flew, Italian genius Leonardo da Vinci drew plans for his "**AERIAL SCREW**," which was designed to be hand-powered by four pilots.

It was never built, and modern scientists believe it would have been **too heavy** to get off the ground.

Did you know?

Leonardo's instructions stated that the aerial screw should be made of reed, wire, and linen for the sail.

Early attempts...



In 1907, Frenchman **PAUL CORNU**'s helicopter rose 1 ft (30 cm) off the ground.



Autogyro

The **AUTOGYRO** was invented in 1923 by Spanish engineer Juan de la Cierva. Like a helicopter, it has a spinning rotor that keeps it airborne. Unlike a helicopter, it is **propelled by the engine**, and not the rotors—which means it can't do the tricks a helicopter can.

Another French inventor, **ETIENNE OEHMICHEN**, created a helicopter that flew 3,280 ft (1 km) in 1924.

